



Nurturing regenerative food systems in a changing climate

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S10.4 - Leverage Points For Sustainable Nutrition Transitions in Hanoi's Food Environment

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Abstract: Urban food environments in emerging economies are rapidly transforming. Understanding these dynamics is crucial for identifying leverage points for sustainable, resilient, and health-promoting change. This study explores shifts in Hanoi's food environment, their drivers, and key intervention points, based on a systematic literature review of both external and personal food environment domains. Using Meadows' leverage points framework, we classified recommended interventions by system characteristics: parameters, feedback, design, and intent.

Since 2008, Hanoi's food environment has undergone significant transitions, expanding from traditional markets to supermarkets, and, more recently, online food platforms. The increasing demand for service and convenience have emerged as dominant trends, alongside a greater diversity of vegetable sources and increasing access to delivery services. However, concerns persist regarding vegetable quality, food waste, and climate-related disruptions to production and logistics. Our findings reveal how globalization, climate change, urbanization, and modern agricultural practices interact with market and consumption patterns to produce mixed outcomes—including reductions in hunger and undernutrition, but also rising health risks (particularly overweight among Hanoi children), food safety concerns, food supply instability, plastic and food waste, and inequitable safe food access.

Identified interventions include promoting short supply chains, increasing consumer awareness, developing behavioral nudges to encourage sustainable consumption (e.g. color-coded stalls to identify sustainable products), and having a dedicated authority focused on monitoring and optimizing multiple system objectives.

The study offers insights for policymakers to foster integrated strategies that address food security, nutrition, public health, resilience, environmental sustainability, and inclusion within Hanoi's food system.

Keywords: sustainable nutrition transitions, urbanization